

02

Central Breaks and Structure Recognition

Choose ...e5, ...c5, ...c6, or patience for a concrete reason



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Make the opening's most important decision by reading the resulting pawn structure.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 007 | PAGE 4

*...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.***Decode: The e5 lock**

LESSON 008 | PAGE 8

*...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.***Play: The e5 lock**

LESSON 009 | PAGE 12

*The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.***Decode: The c5 transformation**

LESSON 010 | PAGE 16

*The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.***Play: The c5 transformation**

LESSON 011 | PAGE 20

*Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.***Decode: The delayed c6 lever**

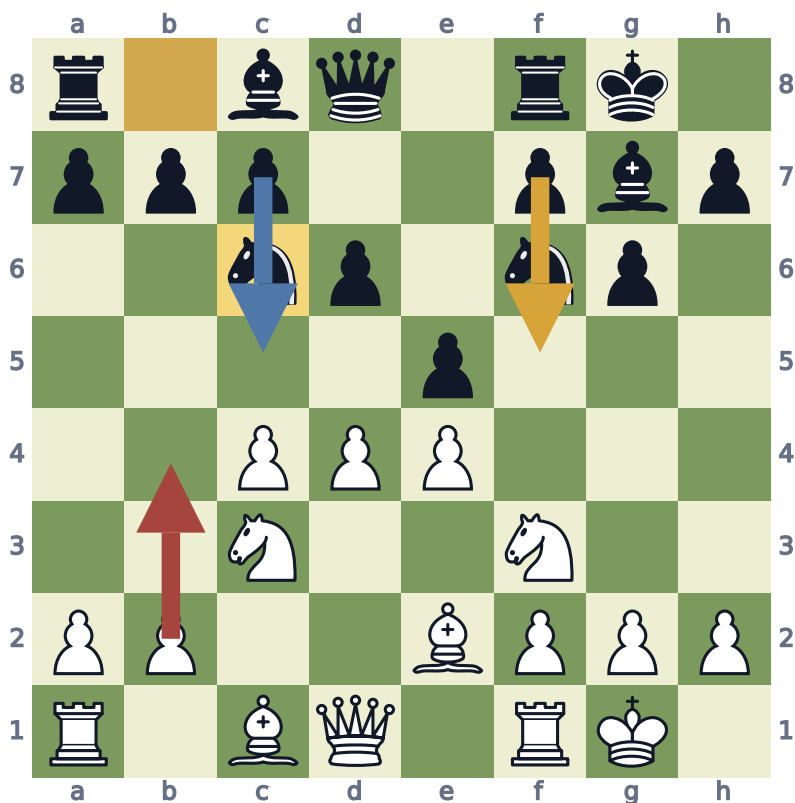
LESSON 012 | PAGE 24

*Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.***Play: The delayed c6 lever****VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Make the opening's most important decision by reading the resulting pawn structure.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e5 lock



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

DECISION RULE

Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...Nd7, ...f5, and often ...Nf6 or ...f4 while keeping c7 and d6 under control.

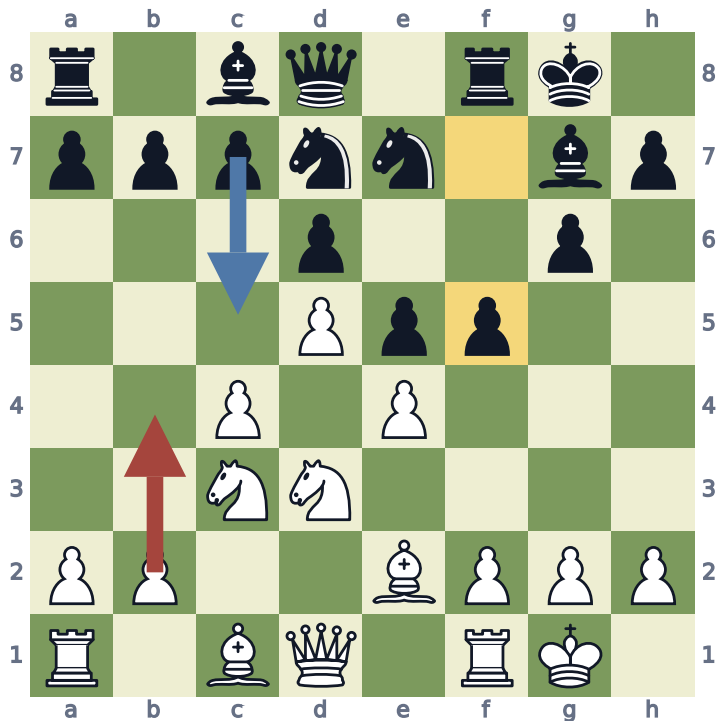
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6.

MEMORY RULE | ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...Nd7, ...f5, and often ...Nf6 or ...f4 while keeping c7 and d6 under control.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6.

FAILURE MODE

Pushing ...f5 before the pieces can use the opened files produces weaknesses rather than an attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

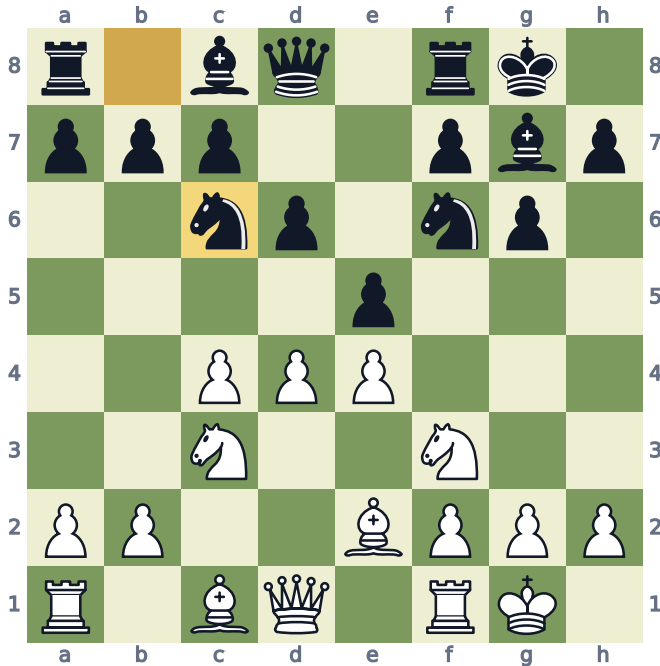
RULE | ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening. White's resistance is: White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6. The line fails as a template when: Pushing ...f5 before the pieces can use the opened files produces weaknesses rather than an attack.

STORE THIS | ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

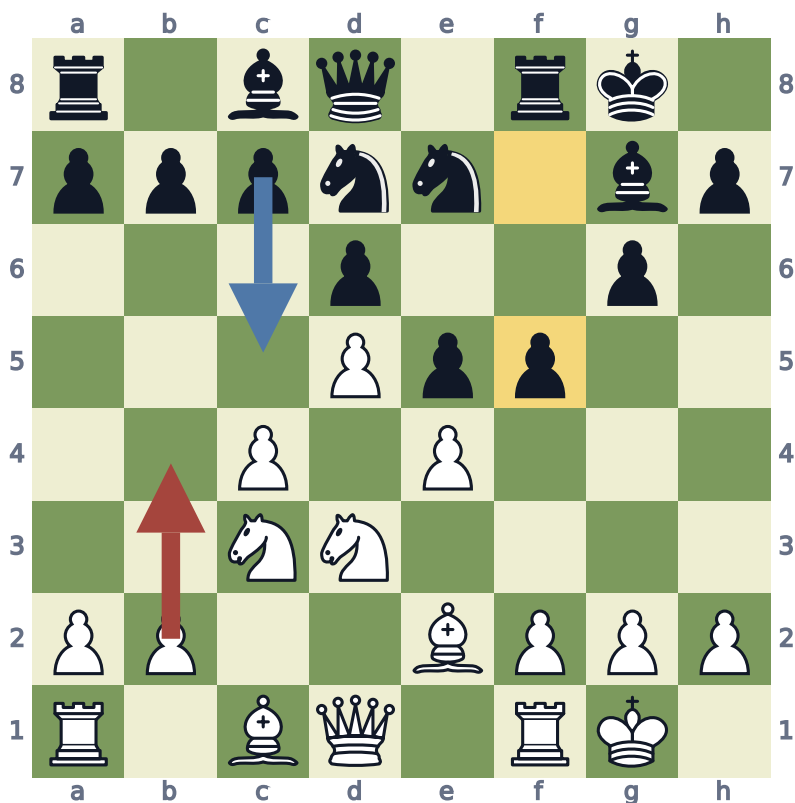
1. The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes. 2. Use ...Nd7, ...f5, and often ...Nf6 or ...f4 while keeping c7 and d6 under control. 3. White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6. 4. Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening. 5. Pushing ...f5 before the pieces can use the opened files produces weaknesses rather than an attack.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e5 lock



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

DECISION RULE

Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...Nd7, ...f5, and often ...Nf6 or ...f4 while keeping c7 and d6 under control.

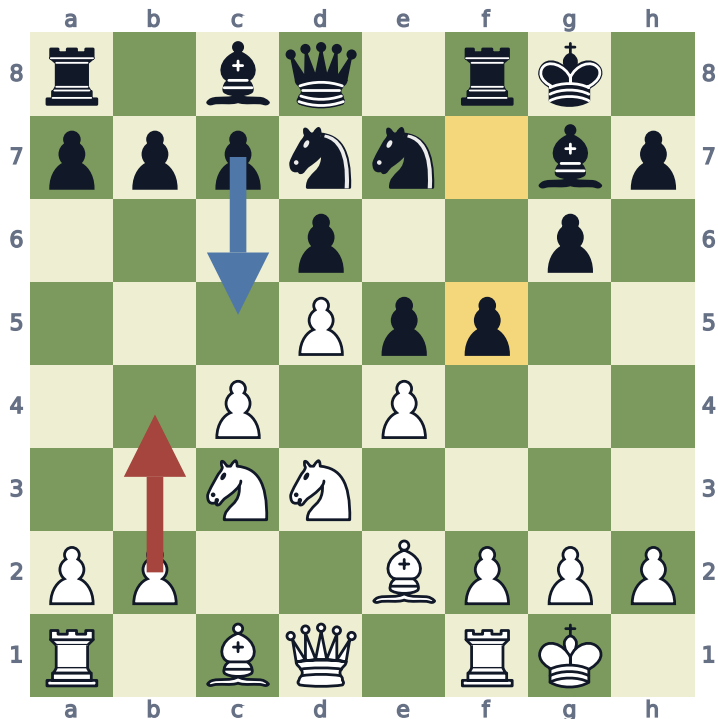
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6.

MEMORY RULE | ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6.

FAILURE MODE

Pushing ...f5 before the pieces can use the opened files produces weaknesses rather than an attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

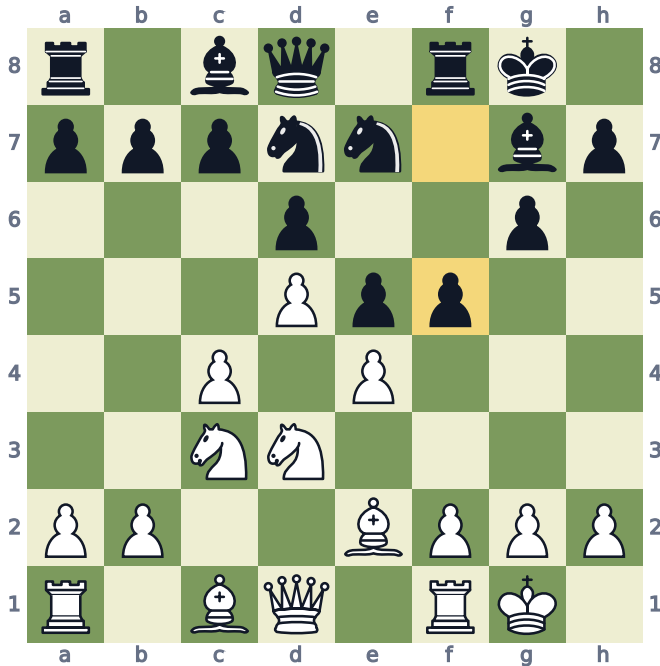
RULE | ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5



- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The ...e5 contact invites d5, after which Black accepts less space in return for a clear kingside break and useful knight routes.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening. White's resistance is: White expands with c5 and b4 and may trade on d6. The line fails as a template when: Pushing ...f5 before the pieces can use the opened files produces weaknesses rather than an attack.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The c5 transformation



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines.

DECISION RULE

Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Attack e4, contest the e-file, and prepare queenside play rather than forcing a kingside race.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space.

MEMORY RULE | The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines.

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space.

FAILURE MODE

Calling every g6-Bg7 position a King's Indian can hide a full transition to Benoni logic.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

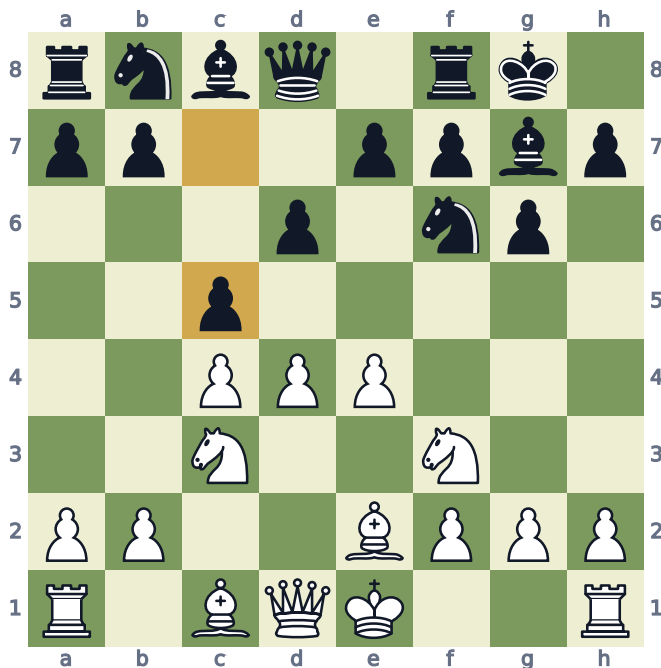
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5 Re8



- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- c5: Black attacks the center from the flank and invites a Benoni-like transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected. White's resistance is: White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space. The line fails as a template when: Calling every g6-Bg7 position a King's Indian can hide a full transition to Benoni logic.

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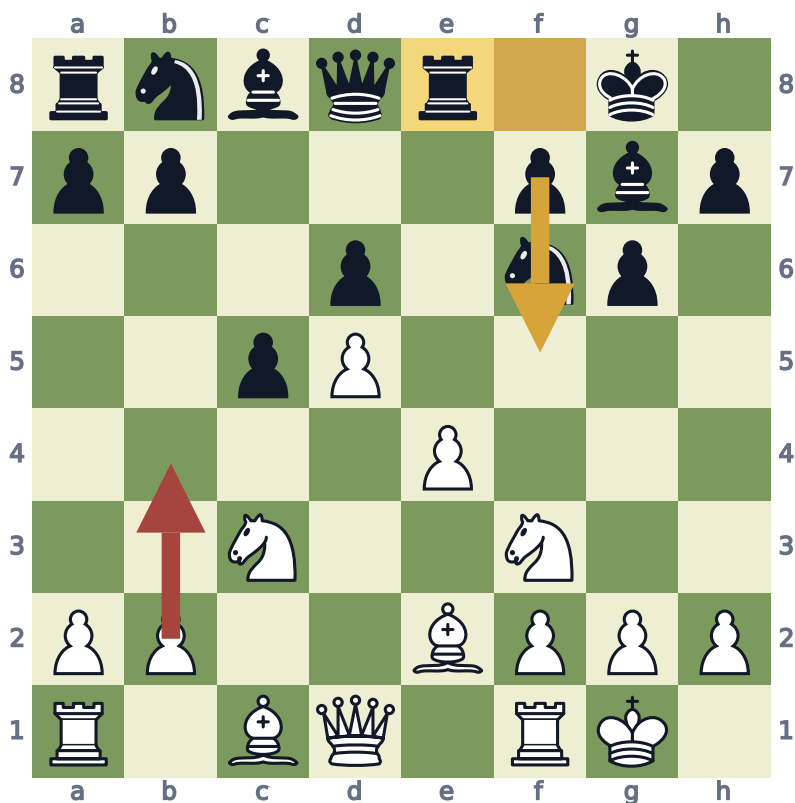
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The c5 transformation



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines.

DECISION RULE

Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Attack e4, contest the e-file, and prepare queenside play rather than forcing a kingside race.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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FAILURE MODE

Calling every g6-Bg7 position a King's Indian can hide a full transition to Benoni logic.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5 Re8



- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- exd5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- cxd5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Re8: Black places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected. White's resistance is: White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space. The line fails as a template when: Calling every g6-Bg7 position a King's Indian can hide a full transition to Benoni logic.

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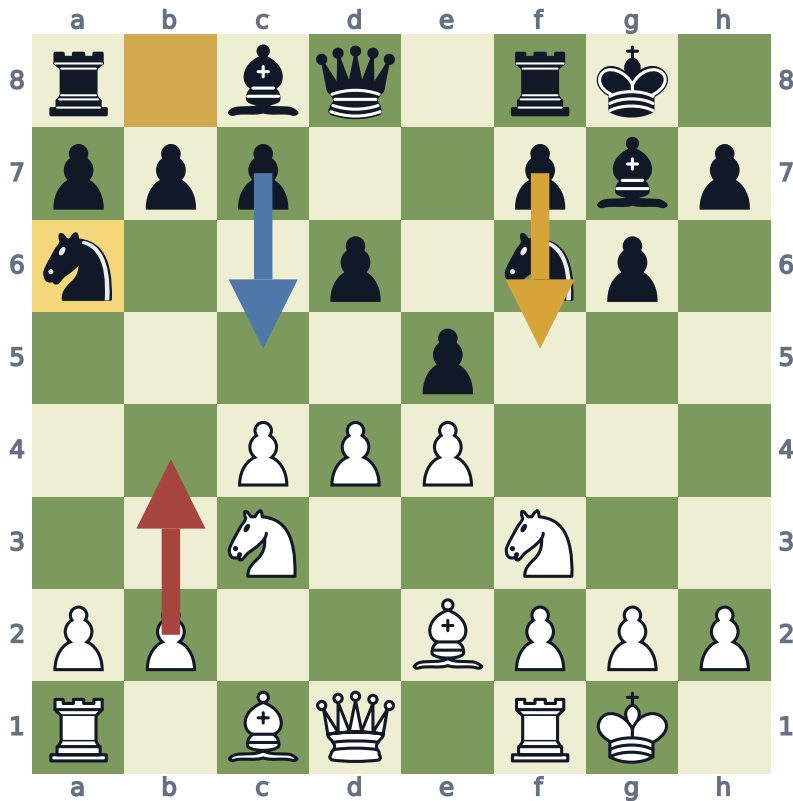
1. The paired breaks ...c5 and ...e6 undermine White's center and can exchange space for targets and active lines. 2. Attack e4, contest the e-file, and prepare queenside play rather than forcing a kingside race. 3. White may advance e5, defend d5, or use b4 to gain space. 4. Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected. 5. Calling every g6-Bg7 position a King's Indian can hide a full transition to Benoni logic.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5 Re8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The delayed c6 lever



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside.

DECISION RULE

Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Keep the center flexible, pressure e4, and use the e-file after exchanges.

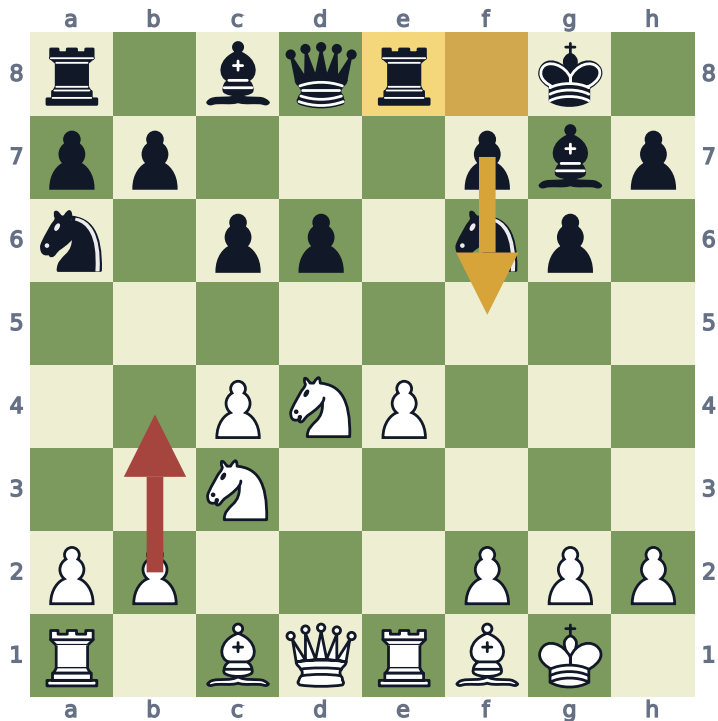
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may hold the center, play d5, or exploit the slower knight on a6.

MEMORY RULE | Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside.

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may hold the center, play d5, or exploit the slower knight on a6.

FAILURE MODE

A preparation move is wasted if the intended break never becomes possible.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

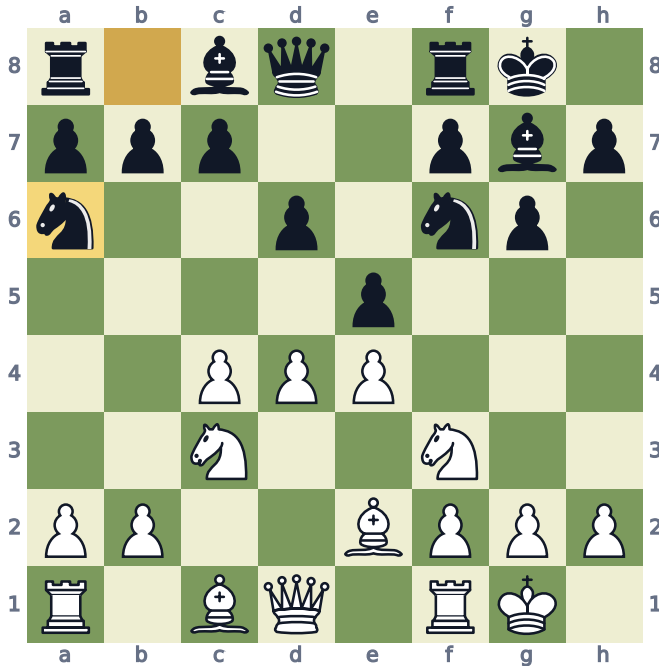
RULE | Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Na6 8. Re1 c6 9. Bf1 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Na6: Black reroutes a knight toward a6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing. White's resistance is: White may hold the center, play d5, or exploit the slower knight on a6. The line fails as a template when: A preparation move is wasted if the intended break never becomes possible.

STORE THIS | Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

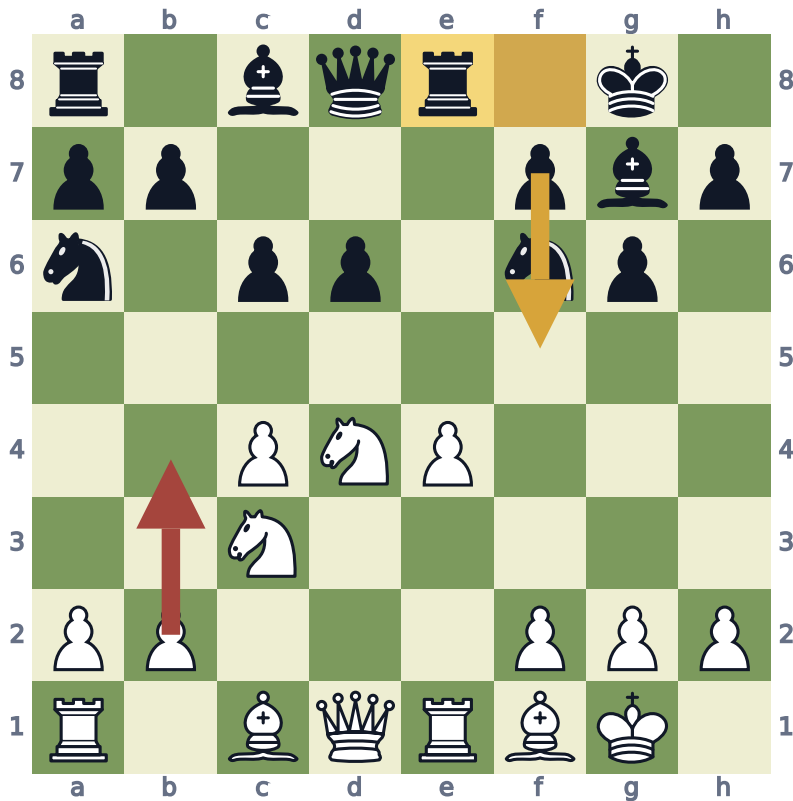
1. ...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside. 2. Keep the center flexible, pressure e4, and use the e-file after exchanges. 3. White may hold the center, play d5, or exploit the slower knight on a6. 4. Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing. 5. A preparation move is wasted if the intended break never becomes possible.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Na6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The delayed c6 lever



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside.

DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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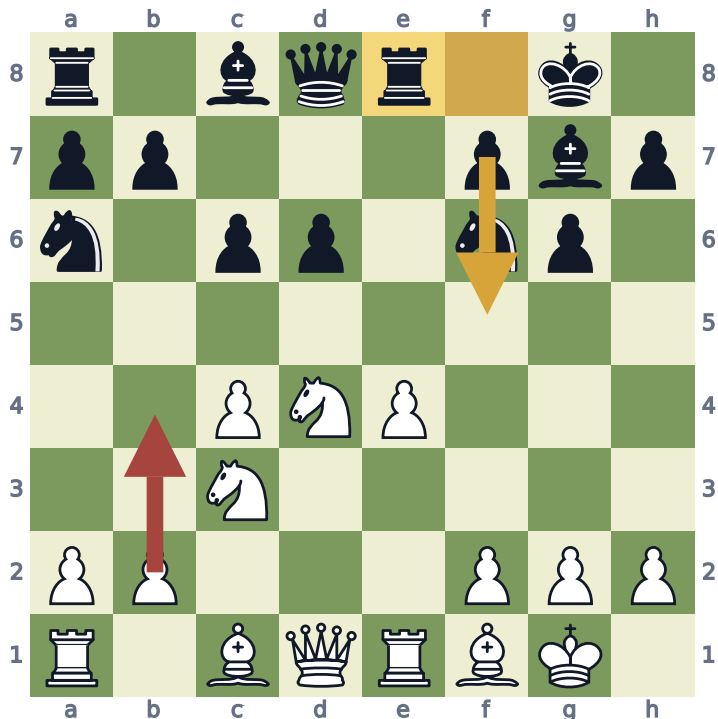
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MEMORY RULE | Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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FAILURE MODE

A preparation move is wasted if the intended break never becomes possible.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Na6 8. Re1 c6 9. Bf1 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8



- Re1: White places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Bf1: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- exd4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nxd4: White reroutes a knight toward d4; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Re8: Black places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

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ANSWER KEY

1. ...c6 can challenge d5, prepare ...Nc5, or support ...d5 without immediately fixing the queenside. 2. Keep the center flexible, pressure e4, and use the e-file after exchanges. 3. White may hold the center, play d5, or exploit the slower knight on a6. 4. Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing. 5. A preparation move is wasted if the intended break never becomes possible.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 c6 9. Bf1 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 007 Decode: The e5 lock

Prompt: Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening.

Recall: ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

LESSON 008 Play: The e5 lock

Prompt: Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening.

Recall: ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

LESSON 009 Decode: The c5 transformation

Prompt: Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected.

Recall: The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.

LESSON 010 Play: The c5 transformation

Prompt: Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected.

Recall: The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.

LESSON 011 Decode: The delayed c6 lever

Prompt: Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing.

Recall: Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

LESSON 012 Play: The delayed c6 lever

Prompt: Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing.

Recall: Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The e5 lock

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5

Decision: Choose the moment of ...f5 by checking whether White can answer with exf5, c5, or a central opening.

Memory: ...e5 asks d5 a question; ...f5 answers the closed center.

CARD 2

The c5 transformation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5 Re8

Decision: Calculate each central capture because the order determines who owns the e-file and whether d5 is weak or protected.

Memory: The pawn skeleton outranks the opening name.

CARD 3

The delayed c6 lever

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Na6 8. Re1 c6 9. Bf1 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8

Decision: Ask whether ...c6 prepares ...d5, invites d5, or merely creates a target before committing.

Memory: Every pawn move must name the transformation it prepares.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
007 Decode: The e5 lock	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
008 Play: The e5 lock	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
009 Decode: The c5 transformation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
010 Play: The c5 transformation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
011 Decode: The delayed c6 lever	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
012 Play: The delayed c6 lever	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.